COMMERCIAL & TECHNOLOGY AUDIT

A Customs Brokerage (ACB)

Customs Broker & Freight Forwarder (US–Latin America) · Doral, Florida

A commercial & technology audit: where revenue leaks around an already-modern client portal — and how to plug it without replacing anything.

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Systems Consulting B2B · CRM · Automation · AI · August 2026

01 Executive summary

A Customs Brokerage (ACB) is a family-owned customs broker and freight forwarder in Doral, FL, in business since 1978 (2nd generation, ~186 employees, offices in Miami, Jacksonville and Savannah, a 40,000 sq ft bonded warehouse and 150+ global agents). Strong US–Latin America lanes (Brazil, Peru, Dominican Republic, Panama, Costa Rica).

ACB is more digitally mature than most: they already run their own client portal ('ACBInsight') with live tracking, document upload and chat. So this is not a 'they have nothing' case — the opportunity is to plug the gaps the portal doesn't cover (quoting, CRM, dormant clients) and connect it to the back office, without replacing anything. Figures are illustrative estimates, to confirm in the audit.

ESTIMATED LEAK (illustrative · to confirm in the audit)

The portal solved post-shipment tracking — but everything before the shipment leaks: quotes built by hand (slow responses, cold leads), a concierge chat answering the same 'where's my cargo?' all day, and no CRM to catch importers who quietly stopped shipping.

› Quoting is manual (email/phone) → in forwarding, the first to quote often wins; delays lose deals.
› The concierge chat handling repetitive status questions is a hidden, non-scalable labor cost.
› No CRM → dormant importers aren't detected or reactivated; the pipeline isn't measurable.
› Illustrative figures; the exact number comes from their data in the audit.

02 Business model — how they make money

- **What they do:** customs clearance, freight forwarding (NVOCC), consolidation, trucking, bonded warehousing, B2B/e-com fulfillment, cargo insurance and trade consulting.
- **Who they serve:** US importers/exporters trading with Latin America (plus Europe/Asia lanes).
- **Coverage:** HQ Doral + Jacksonville + Savannah; 40,000 sq ft bonded warehouse; 150+ global agents.
- **Scale:** since 1978 (2nd gen), ~186 employees; CBP filer MH9, ACE-certified, NVOCC-licensed.

03 How they get customers

- Own client portal 'ACBInsight' (live tracking, doc upload, concierge chat) — post-shipment is solved.
- But quoting is manual (email/phone); no online quote engine.
- No visible CRM or internal IT team; the 'concierge' human-touch model is the differentiator (and a cost).

04 Digital presence & tech observed

PUBLIC SOURCES ONLY · WHAT CAN'T BE VERIFIED IS MARKED «NOT OBSERVABLE»

TOOL	STATUS	OBSERVATION
Website + ACBInsight portal	Confirmed	Modern site + own client portal with live tracking & doc upload.
Tracking backend	Confirmed	Portal wraps a 3rd-party tracking API (Open Track) → integration upside.
Online quoting	Not found	No quote engine; quotes likely manual by email/phone.
TMS / ERP	Not observable	Possibly a forwarding TMS (Magaya/CargoWise); not confirmed.
CRM	Not observable	No signs; sales likely in Outlook/Excel.
Internal IT / LinkedIn	Not found	No visible tech roles among ~186 staff.

05 Where they're losing money

LEAK POINTS DETECTED FROM OBSERVABLE SIGNALS

- Manual quoting (biggest leak) → slow, inconsistent quotes; leads go cold while they wait.
- Data silos → ACBInsight (tracking/docs) likely not integrated with customs/billing/sales → re-keying, errors.
- No CRM → dormant importers unnoticed; pipeline not measurable; recurring revenue leaks.
- Labor-intensive customs docs (HTS classification, ISF, matching invoices/BLs) → bottleneck + CBP/FDA penalty risk.
- Concierge chat as hidden cost → agents answering the same status questions all day.

06 Prioritized opportunities

BY ECONOMIC IMPACT AND EASE OF IMPLEMENTATION

OPPORTUNITY	WHAT IT SOLVES	IMPACT	PRIORITY
Online quote engine / copilot	Quotes in minutes; win the deals speed decides	More sales	VERY HIGH
CRM + dormant-client scoring	Detect & reactivate importers who stopped shipping	Revenue recovery	VERY HIGH
AI document extraction for customs	OCR/LLM pre-fills entries; fewer penalties	Fewer errors / risk	HIGH
Integrate ACBInsight ↔ back office	One data flow; no re-keying	Efficiency	HIGH
Status-question chatbot	Deflects 60-70% of 'where's my cargo?'	Cost savings	MEDIUM

07 Leak quantification (CFO view)

ESTIMATE WITH ASSUMPTIONS · INVESTMENT IN TIERS ($ low · $$ mid · $$$ high), TO BE DEFINED

PROBLEM	IMPACT	EST. ANNUAL COST	SOLUTION	IN V.
Manual quoting	Slow quotes + cold leads	Lost deals	Quote engine / copilot	$ $
System silos / re-keying	Hours + errors	Variable	ACBInsight ↔ back-office integration	$ $
No CRM (dormant clients)	Lost recurring revenue	Variable	CRM + churn scoring	$
Manual customs docs	Hours + penalty risk	Variable + risk	AI document extraction	$ $
Concierge status queries	Hidden labor cost	Variable	Status chatbot	$

08 Hidden opportunities (AI & data)

WHAT ALMOST NO CONSULTANCY LOOKS AT

- AI/OCR extraction of invoices, packing lists and BLs → auto-prefill customs entries + suggest HTS codes.
- Quoting copilot from historical rates + a bot answering 'where's my cargo?' from the same tracking data.
- Churn/dormant-client scoring over shipment history → alert sales before revenue leaks.

09 What we cover in the free audit

INTERNAL AREAS AREN'T PUBLIC — THIS IS THE NO-COST DISCOVERY

- How quotes are built and how long responses take today.
- What ACBInsight connects to (customs system, billing) and where re-keying happens.
- How the sales pipeline and dormant clients are tracked (if at all).
- Where the customs-doc bottleneck and penalty risk sit.
- From that: the exact $ leak and a phased ROI roadmap.

10 Phased proposal

Approach: **build on top of what exists**, highest impact and lowest effort first.

PHASE 1 · VERY HIGH — Win before the shipment

Online quote engine/copilot + CRM with dormant-client alerts.

PHASE 2 · HIGH — Cut the doc bottleneck

AI document extraction + ACBInsight ↔ back-office integration.

PHASE 3 · MEDIUM — Scale the concierge

Status-question chatbot on top of existing tracking data.

11 Entry angle

> *«You already nailed post-shipment visibility with ACBInsight — but everything before the shipment (quoting, and the follow-up on clients who quietly stopped importing) still runs on email and memory. That's where forwarders leak the most revenue. I plug that gap by building on top of what you already have, not replacing it.»*

12 Arguments for decision-makers

President (Gabriel Rodriguez): Optimize what your father built — win more quotes and keep clients, without touching ACBInsight.

EVP (Fernando Rodriguez): Automate quoting and customs docs to free your team and cut penalty risk.

CFO: Faster quotes win more deals; document automation cuts hours and CBP/FDA exposure — measurable at your volume.

13 Summary: findings & solutions

AREA	FINDING	SOLUTION
Quoting	Manual by email/phone	Online quote engine/copilot
Sales	No CRM; dormant clients unseen	CRM + churn scoring
Customs docs	Manual classification/matching	AI document extraction
Systems	ACBInsight siloed from back office	Integration layer
Support	Concierge answers repetitive status	Status chatbot

14 Conclusion

ACB already did the hard, forward-looking thing (their own client portal). The money leaking now is upstream — manual quoting, no CRM, labor-heavy customs docs — and around the portal, not inside it.

Building on top of ACBInsight — a quote engine, a CRM and AI document handling — is low-risk (nothing is replaced) and high-return, and it respects what the family built.

Let's start with a no-cost initial audit

We map your real process and hand you the exact $ leak and an ROI roadmap. No obligation.

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CRM · ERP · Dashboards · Automation · AI Solutions

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